



Action Plan

RECRUIT at least 6,000 more spies in the IB within the next three months.

REVIVE covert operations by RAW and IB for them to infiltrate terrorist networks.

MAKE all the information given by intelligence agencies actionable and accountable by grading the inputs.

DEVELOP a central database of inputs which can be accessible to all intelligence units and be a reservoir for information.

STRENGTHEN the intelligence gathering ability of the local police stations.

Experts' Opinions

Seasoned spies offer their viewpoints on the vital issue of revamping India's intelligence system

VIKRAM SOOD



Former
R&AW
Chief

■ Focus on human intelligence and make it a long-term commitment.

■ Strong leadership is needed but from within the organisation.

R.S. BEDI



Former
NTRO
Chief

■ Implement the findings of the Kargil Review Committee's task force on intelligence.

■ Make a single agency responsible for the analysis of all intelligence inputs.

A.S. DULAT



Former
R&AW
Chief

■ Vacancies in the intelligence agencies need to be filled up on priority.

■ Quality of agents and assets on ground needs to be improved.

gence gathering agencies, the importance of the local police, especially the beat constable, cannot be undermined. He is the most crucial link in the chain since he is the one who has maximum interface with the people. As Chidambaram says, "The local police station is the best source of information." The local police and its intelligence units need to be beefed up for better and grounded information.

Over the years, the focus has shifted more on technical intelligence with human aspect not paid too much importance. Efforts to infiltrate terrorist outfits need to be intensified.

This is not to say that technical intelligence should be ignored. In fact, the country should use its best available brains to upgrade cyber intelligence. Innovative ideas need to be infused in the system. While terrorists keep changing their modus operandi and technology, intelligence officials have remained boxed in with their old bureaucratised way of thinking. Another important aspect of enhancing intelligence is ensuring that existing agencies work to their optimum. In addition to filling up vacant posts, it is imperative that these agencies have the best people and technology.